

Christmas Eve
December 24, 2025
5:30 & 7:30 P.M.

A BLESSED CHRISTMAS TO EACH OF YOU!

We welcome each of you to this Christmas Eve Bethlehem moment. You’ve each had to take steps to come to this moment in Bethlehem. Some of the steps have come easy ... some have been challenging. But each step is worthwhile. As you walk into this Sanctuary, imagine that you are opening the door of the Bethlehem barn, smelling the animals, hearing the sound of your feet on the dry straw, and seeing with your own eyes the One who took the step from heaven to earth 2000 years ago. Fall on your knees and worship the newborn King.

A SPECIAL WELCOME TO OUR GUESTS

We are especially happy that you are worshiping with us this special night. We hope that you have a wonderful worship experience and that you will come back soon to Living Savior to experience the gifts of God.

Pre-Service Music

A TIME OF GATHERING

Please stand

Entrance Hymn

“O Come, All Ye Faithful” #379



1 O come, all ye faith - ful, Joy - ful and tri - um - phant! O
2 High - est, most ho - ly, Light of Light e - ter - nal,
3 Sing, choirs of an - gels, Sing in ex - ul - ta - tion,
4 Yea, Lord, we greet Thee, Born this hap - py morn - ing;



come ye, O come__ ye to Beth - le - hem;
Born of a vir - gin, a mor - tal He comes;
Sing, all ye cit - i - zens of heav - en a - bove!
Je - sus, to Thee__ be__ glo - ry giv'n!



Come and be - hold Him Born the king of an - gels:
 Son of the Fa - ther Now in flesh ap - pear - ing!
 Glo - ry to God In the high - est:
 Word of the Fa - ther Now in flesh ap - pear - ing!

Refrain



O come, let us a - dore Him, O come, let us a - dore Him,
 O come, let us a - dore Him, Christ the Lord!

Text: tr. Frederick Oakeley, 1802–80, alt.
 Text and tune: John F. Wade, c. 1711–1786
 Text and tune: Public domain

Invocation

The sign of the cross may be made by all in remembrance of their Baptism.

P In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit.

C Amen.

P This night shines, O God. . .

C “Glory to God in the highest heaven!”

P . . . shines with heaven’s glory. . .

C “Glory to God in the highest heaven!”

P . . . shines with angel-light. . .

C “Glory to God in the highest heaven!”

P . . . shines with the light of the TRUE LIGHT which enlightens everyone!

C “Glory to God in the highest heaven!”

P Your Son, born an infant in Bethlehem’s stable, SHINES in our world . . . in our hearts . . . in our lives.

C “Glory to God in the highest heaven!”

P Shine on, O Glorious God. Shine on . . . that, so filled with the light of your love, we may see our future in heaven’s eternal light.

C “On earth peace among those whom God favors!”

P Through Jesus Christ, your Son, our Lord. He lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now,

C and forever. Amen.

The Hymn of Praise

“Go Tell It on the Mountain” #388

Refrain



Go tell it on the moun - tain, O-ver the hills and ev - 'ry - where;



Go tell it on the moun - tain That Je - sus Christ is born!



1 While shep-herds kept their watch-ing O'er si - lent flocks by night,
 2 The shep-herds feared and trem - bled When lo, a - bove the earth
 3 Down in a lone - ly man - ger The hum-ble Christ was born;

Refrain



Be - hold, through - out the heav - ens There shone a ho - ly light.
 Rang out the an - gel cho - rus That hailed our Sav - ior's birth.
 And God sent us sal - va - tion That bless - ed Christ - mas morn.

Text (sts. 1–3): John W. Work II, 1873–1925, alt.
 Text (ref) and tune: African American spiritual
 Text and tune: Public domain

The Salutation and the Prayer of the Day

P The Lord be with you.

C And also with you.

P Let us pray: O God, because you once caused this holy night to shine with the brightness of the true Light, grant that we who have known the mystery of that Light here on earth may come to the full measure of its joy in heaven; through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C Amen.

Please be seated

WE HEAR GOD’S WORD

First Lesson

Isaiah 7:10-14

¹⁰Again the LORD spoke to Ahaz, ¹¹“Ask a sign of the LORD your God; let it be deep as Sheol or high as heaven.” ¹²But Ahaz said, “I will not ask, and I will not put the LORD to the test.” ¹³And he said, “Hear then, O house of David! Is it too little for you to weary men, that you weary my God also? ¹⁴Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign. Behold, the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.”

L This is the Word of the Lord.

C Thanks be to God.

The Anthem

5:30 “E’en So Lord Jesus, Quickly Come” Paul Manz
Meghan Benson, soloist

7:30 “Lo, How a Rose E’er Blooming” Chancel Choir

Second Lesson

1 John 4:7-16

⁷Beloved, let us love one another, for love is from God, and whoever loves has been born of God and knows God. ⁸Anyone who does not love does not know God, because God is love. ⁹In this the love of God was made manifest among us, that God sent his only Son into the world, so that we might live through him. ¹⁰In this is love, not that we have loved God but that he loved us and sent his Son to be the propitiation for our sins. ¹¹Beloved, if God so loved us, we also ought to love one another. ¹²No one has ever seen God; if we love one another, God abides in us and his love is perfected in us.

¹³By this we know that we abide in him and he in us, because he has given us of his Spirit. ¹⁴And we have seen and testify that the Father has sent his Son to be the Savior of the world. ¹⁵Whoever confesses that Jesus is the Son of God, God abides in him, and he in God. ¹⁶So we have come to know and to believe the love that God has for us. God is love, and whoever abides in love abides in God, and God abides in him.

L This is the Word of the Lord.

C Thanks be to God.

Please stand

The Verse

Christmas

Based on Luke 2:11

Wallace Horton

Joyfully

Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. To
you is born this day a Sa - vior Christ the Lord. To
you is born this day a Sa - vior Christ the Lord. Al -
le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al -
le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia.

Holy Gospel

Matthew 1:18-25

P The Holy Gospel according to St. Matthew, the first chapter.

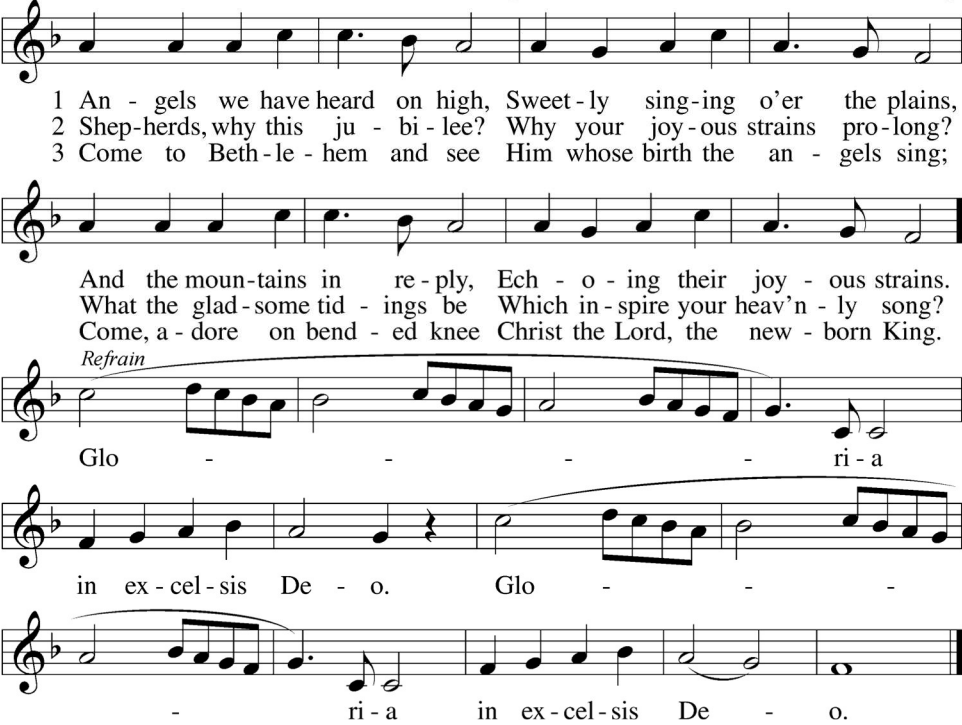
C Glory to You, O Lord.

¹⁸Now the birth of Jesus Christ took place in this way. When his mother Mary had been betrothed to Joseph, before they came together she was found to be with child from the Holy Spirit. ¹⁹And her husband Joseph, being a just man and unwilling to put her to shame, resolved to divorce her quietly. ²⁰But as he considered these things, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, “Joseph, son of David, do not fear to take Mary as your wife, for that which is conceived in her is from the Holy Spirit. ²¹She will bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus, for he will save his people from their sins.” ²²All this took place to fulfill what the Lord had spoken by the prophet: ²³“Behold, the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and they shall call his name Immanuel” (which

means, God with us). ²⁴When Joseph woke from sleep, he did as the angel of the Lord commanded him: he took his wife, ²⁵but knew her not until she had given birth to a son. And he called his name Jesus.

- Ⓟ This is the Gospel of the Lord.
- Ⓒ **Praise to You, O Christ.**

The Christmas Carol **“Angels We Have Heard on High” #368**



1 An - gels we have heard on high, Sweet - ly sing - ing o'er the plains,
2 Shep - herds, why this ju - bi - lee? Why your joy - ous strains pro - long?
3 Come to Beth - le - hem and see Him whose birth the an - gels sing;

And the moun - tains in re - ply, Ech - o - ing their joy - ous strains.
What the glad - some tid - ings be Which in - spire your heav'n - ly song?
Come, a - dore on bend - ed knee Christ the Lord, the new - born King.

Refrain

Glo - ri - a

in ex - cel - sis De - o. Glo - ri - a

ri - a in ex - cel - sis De - o.

Text: tr. The Crown of Jesus, 1862, Part 2, London, alt.
Text and tune: French
Text and tune: Public domain

Please be seated

The Christmas Message

Pastor Bill Mann

Please stand

The Christmas Carol **“What Child is This” #370**



1 What child is this, who, laid to rest, On Mar - y's lap is
2 Why lies He in such mean es - tate Where ox and ass are
3 So bring Him in - cense, gold, and myrrh; Come, peas - ant, king, to

sleep - ing? Whom an - gels greet with an - thems sweet While
feed - ing? Good Chris - tian, fear; for sin - ners here The
own Him. The King of kings sal - va - tion brings; Let

shep - herds watch are keep - ing? This, this is
si - lent Word is plead - ing. Nails, spear shall
lov - ing hearts en - throne Him. Raise, raise the

Christ the king, Whom shep - herds guard and an - gels sing;
pierce Him through, The cross be borne for me, for you;
song on high, The vir - gin sings her lul - la - by;

Haste, haste to bring Him laud, The babe, the son of Mar - y!
Hail, hail the Word made flesh, The babe, the son of Mar - y!
Joy, joy, for Christ is born, The babe, the son of Mar - y!

Text: William C. Dix, 1837–98
Tune: English, 16th cent.
Text and tune: Public domain

The Statement of Faith

Luther's Explanation to the 2nd article of the Apostles' Creed

- Ⓟ We confess our faith.
- Ⓒ **I believe that Jesus Christ, true God, begotten of the Father from eternity, and also true man, born of the Virgin Mary, is my Lord, who has redeemed me, a lost and condemned person, purchased and won me from all sins, from death, and from the power of the devil; not with gold or silver, but with his holy, precious blood and**

with his innocent suffering and death, that I may be his own, and live under him in his kingdom, and serve him in everlasting righteousness, innocence, and blessedness, just as he is risen from the dead, lives and reigns to all eternity. This is most certainly true.

Please be seated

WE GIVE THANKS TO GOD AND RECEIVE HIS GIFT TO US

The Christmas Offerings of God’s People

(Whether you give your tithes and offerings in-person or electronically, it is during this Act of Worship when we are mindful of everything that God gives to us).

Offering Music

5:30 “Mary, Did You Know?” arr. Larson
Meghan Benson and Carolyn Reyes, soloists

7:30 “Lo, How a Rose E’er Blooming” Chancel Choir

Please stand

The Offertory “Joy to the World” #387 (v. 1)

1 Joy to the world, the Lord is come! Let earth re-ceive her
King; Let ev-'ry heart pre-pare Him
room And heav'n and na-ture sing, And heav'n and na-ture
sing, And heav'n, and heav'n and na-ture sing.

Text: Isaac Watts, 1674–1748
Tune: George Frideric Handel, 1685–1759, adapt.
Text and tune: Public domain

The Prayers of the Church

- P** Dear God, in the mystery of the Word made flesh you revealed your love to all the world. Teach us to love others as you have loved us. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Dear God, in the mystery of the Word made flesh, you revealed the unity of purpose with the Son and the Holy Spirit. Help all Christians who live in this world fractured by sin to be one in faith and purpose. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Dear God, in the mystery of the Word made flesh You gave the world the hope that never fades. Give to all who are despondent, ill, or grieving a hopeful faith that trusts in you for forgiveness, life, and salvation. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Dear God, in the mystery of the Word made flesh you proclaimed peace on earth and good will toward mankind. Remove all causes and occasions for war, terrorism, and other evils between nations and open wide the doors that have been shut to the proclamation of the Gospel, that many more may know your peace that passes all human understanding. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Dear God, you embodied your Word in Jesus, your Son. Embody, we pray, your Word in those called to preach and teach, that your people would be preserved from all error and that your light would scatter the darkness. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Dear God, we thank you for all who have gone before us in faith and now kneel before you in heaven. Keep us faithful, so that one day we might join them kneeling before you in gratitude, wonder, and praise. Lord, in your mercy,
- C hear our prayer.**
- P** Into your hands, O Lord, we commend all for whom we pray, trusting in your mercy; through your Son, Jesus Christ, our Lord.
- C Amen.**

The Lord’s Prayer
Order of Holy Communion

✝ The Words of Institution

P The peace of the Lord be with you always.
C And also with you.

Please be seated

The Distribution

Communion Hymn “Away in a Manger” #364



1 A - way in a man - ger, no crib for a bed,
2 The cat - tle are low - ing, the ba - by a - wakes,
3 Be near me, Lord Je - sus; I ask Thee to stay



The lit - tle Lord Je - sus laid down His sweet head.
But lit - tle Lord Je - sus, no cry - ing He makes.
Close by me for - ev - er and love me, I pray.



The stars in the sky — looked down where He lay,
I love Thee, Lord Je - sus! Look down from the sky,
Bless all the dear chil - dren in Thy ten - der care,



The lit - tle Lord Je - sus a - sleep on the hay.
And stay by my cra - dle till morn - ing is nigh.
And take us to heav - en to live with Thee there.

Text (sts. 1–2): Little Children’s Book, 1885, Philadelphia; (st. 3): Vineyard Songs, 1892, Louisville, alt.
Tune: James R. Murray, 1841–1905
Text and tune: Public domain

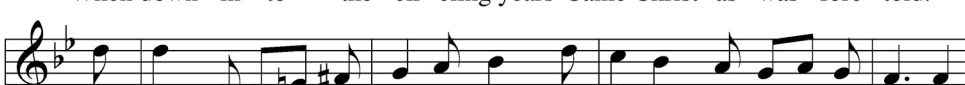
Communion Hymn “It Came Upon the Midnight Clear” #366



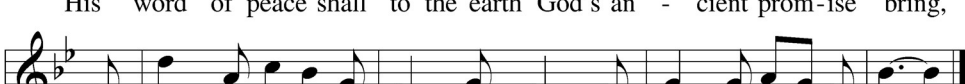
1 It came up - on the mid - night clear, That glo - rious song of old,
2 Still through the clo - ven skies they come With peace - ful wings un - furled,
3 All you, be - neath your heav - y load, By care and guilt bent low,
4 For lo, the days have come to pass By proph - ets seen of old,



From an - gels bend - ing near the earth To touch their harps of gold:
And still their heav’n - ly mu - sic floats O’er all the wea - ry world.
Who toil a - long a drea - ry way With pain - ful steps and slow:
When down in - to the cir - cling years Came Christ as was fore - told.



“Peace on the earth, good - will to all, From heav’n’s all - gra - cious king.”
A - bove its sad and low - ly plains They bend on hov - ’ring wing,
Look up, for gold - en is the hour, Come swift - ly on the wing,
His word of peace shall to the earth God’s an - cient prom - ise bring,



The world in sol - emn still - ness lay To hear the an - gels sing.
And ev - er o’er its ba - bel sounds The bless - ed an - gels sing.
The Prince was born to bring you peace; Of Him the an - gels sing.
And all who take this gift will hear The song the an - gels sing.

Text: Edmund H. Sears, 1810–76, alt.
Tune: Richard S. Willis, 1819–1900
Text and tune: Public domain

Communion Hymn “Of the Father’s Love Begotten” #384

1 Of the Fa - ther's love be - got - ten Ere the worlds be -
2 Oh, that birth for - ev - er bless - ed, When the vir - gin,
3 This is He whom seers in old time Chant - ed of with
4 O ye heights of heav'n, a - dore Him; An - gel hosts, His
△ 5 Christ, to Thee, with God the Fa - ther, And, O Ho - ly

gan to be, He is Al - pha and O - me - ga,
full of grace, By the Ho - ly Ghost con - ceiv - ing,
one ac - cord, Whom the voic - es of the proph - ets
prais - es sing. Pow'rs, do - min - ions, bow be - fore Him
Ghost, to Thee Hymn and chant and high thanks - giv - ing

He the source, the end - ing He, Of the things that are, that
Bore the Sav - ior of our race, And the babe, the world's Re -
Prom - ised in their faith - ful word. Now He shines, the long - ex -
And ex - tol our God and King. Let no tongue on earth be -
And un - end - ing prais - es be, Hon - or, glo - ry, and do -

have been, And that fu - ture years shall see
deem - er, First re - vealed His sa - cred face
pect - ed; Let cre - a - tion praise its Lord
si - lent, Ev - 'ry voice in con - cert ring
min - ion, And e - ter - nal vic - to - ry

Ev - er - more and ev - er - more.
Ev - er - more and ev - er - more.
Ev - er - more and ev - er - more.
Ev - er - more and ev - er - more.
Ev - er - more and ev - er - more. A - men.

Text: Aurelius Prudentius Clemens, 348–c. 413; (sts. 1–4): tr. John Mason Neale, 1818–66, alt.; (st. 5): tr. Henry W. Baker, 1821–77
Tune: Plainsong, 13th cent., mode V
Text and tune: Public domain

Please stand
The Christ Light is Shared
The Pastor gives the light to the ushers who then give light to the worshipers. The lighted candle is never tilted but is always held upright when giving light to another.

- P** As the light of these candles illumines our faces, it symbolizes the Light of Christ, seen in the Child lying in the manger at Bethlehem, flickering brightly on a cross outside Jerusalem, exploding from a tomb on Easter morn and brightly shining in your heart. Jesus is our Light here on earth and the eternal Light Who enlightens heaven. Rejoice on this night for the Light of the world as come, the Light Who transforms us to shine with the brightness of His glory.
- C** **We reflect the Lord’s glory and are being transformed into His likeness, with ever increasing glory, which comes from the Lord.**

The Candlelight Carol “Silent Night” #363

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God,

all is bright Round yon vir - gin moth - er and child.
at the sight; Glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far,
love's pure light Ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face

Ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild, Sleep in heav - en - ly
Heav'n - ly hosts sing, Al - le - lu - ia! Christ, the Sav - ior, is
With the dawn of re - deem - ing grace, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy

peace, Sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
born! Christ, the Sav - ior, is born!
birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.

Text: Franz Joseph Mohr, 1792–1848; tr. John F. Young, 1820–85
Tune: Franz Xaver Gruber, 1787–1863
Text and tune: Public domain

WE ARE SENT INTO THE WORLD

The Benediction

P The Lord bless you and keep you; The Lord make His face shine upon you and be gracious to you; The Lord look upon you with favor, and ✠ give you peace.



C A - men.

Please extinguish your candle

Dismissal Hymn

“Hark! The Herald Angels Sing” #380



1 Hark! The her - ald an - gels sing, "Glo - ry to the new - born King;
2 Christ, by high - est heav'n a - dored, Christ, the ev - er - last - ing Lord,
3 Hail, the heav'n-born Prince of Peace! Hail, the Sun of Righ-teous-ness!



Peace on earth and mer - cy mild, God and sin - ners rec - on - ciled!"
Late in time be - hold Him come, Off - spring of a vir - gin's womb.
Light and life to all He brings, Ris'n with heal - ing in His wings.



Joy - ful, all ye na - tions, rise, Join the tri - umph of the skies;
Veiled in flesh the God-head see, Hail the in-car - nate De - i - ty!
Mild He lays His glo - ry by, Born that man no more may die,



With the an-gel - ic host pro-claim, "Christ is born in Beth-le-hem!"
Pleased as Man with man to dwell, Je - sus, our Im-man-u - el!
Born to raise the sons of earth, Born to give them sec-ond birth.



Hark! The her-ald an-gels sing, "Glo-ry to the new-born King!"

Text: Charles Wesley, 1707–88, alt.
Tune: Felix Mendelssohn, 1809–47
Text and tune: Public domain

Postlude “Break Forth into Joy” from *The Christmas Oratorio* J. S. Bach

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Minister of Worship/Music

Music Assistant

Preschool Director

Rev. Bill Mann

Dr. Wallace Horton

Candie Jefferson

Sarah Lasmanis

**Join Us for Worship on Sundays at
8:30 AM and 11:00 AM (livestreamed)**

9:50 AM - Sunday School and Adult Education

***May the joy of our Lord's birth fill your hearts
to overflowing this season and throughout the year!***

✠ ✠

Acknowledgments

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